

Mis/Disinformation identified on Twitter/X

Context:

The July 20th "Chalo Sansad" protest, which started due to NEET exam leaks and was followed by student suicides -**Twitter**, a real-time microblogging platform, saw a surge in mis/disinformation and fact check contents. With the genuine contents, the platform got flooded with recycled celebrity clips, mislabelled violence, and fabricated contents. Independent fact checkers (BOOM,AltNews,...) and government channels highlighted X's failure to control such unverified contents.

Threats and vulnerabilities:

- **False claims about public figures increased credibility:** Clip [of Sunita Williams](#) (Kerala-Lit-Fest) from Jan,2026 was shared as her joining the protest. The handle [@Coacroach_party](#) posted: *"ma'm sunita william at jantar mantar. Our real hero.."*, [EN trans: *"ma'am Sunita Williams at Jantar Mantar. Our real hero."*], gained thousands engagement before fact-checks.
- **Old footage used to shift blame:** A June,2026 [Patna stone-pelting clip](#) was recast as protestors attacking hydrogen train near Delhi. BJP's Mishra posted: *"...स्टेशन पर खड़ी हाईड्रोजन ट्रेन पर पथराव..."* [EN trans: *...Stone-pelting at the hydrogen train stationed at the platform...*].
- **Fabricated police violence claims went viral before official fact arrived:** posts claimed of [pellet gun use](#) by security forces, came out to be *"completely false"* per Delhi Police. [Rumours of Army deployment](#) were dismissed as *"propaganda"*, yet these false contents reached hundred-thousands of engagements before rebuttals surfaced.
- **Context-stripping of authentic footage complicated the verification:** [video clip of actor "Naseeruddin Shah"](#) in Mumbai (July 15) was falsified for his appearance at the Delhi protest. This delayed corrections, allowed the narrative to grow while awaiting verifications.
- **Cross-app amplification** using screenshots and reshares spread fabricated contents to Telegram, Facebook, YouTube, and Instagram, often without corrections. **Sunita Williams** clip for instance reached across Hindi feeds where users engaged believing it was recent, proving containment of narrative fails once it reaches multi-platform saturation.

Risk assessment:

- **Short-term:** The unverified claims of police brutality, risks escalating situation on the ground, especially with over [60 demonstrators and 118 police personnel are already injured](#) during the clashes.
- **Medium-term:** The archived clips remain searchable, may be used for shaping public perception of state-citizen relationship long after the protest ends.
- **Long-term:** High profile mis-informational claims, by verified handles -can erode the public trust in factcheckers and authentic sources. Delhi Police has warned of [legal actions against such handles](#), signalling growing fatigue against disinformation.
- **Key Accelerants are:** Political polarisation, emotional weight of student suicides, and repurposing of old archived clips that can make platform moderation more reactive during future unrests.